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Course: 21LEM202T - Universal Human Values - II

Unit – 5 : Session – 8 | Humanistic Education as the Entry Point

Part C — Long-Answer Questions (Solutions)

1. Q1. HUMANISTIC EDUCATION AS THE ENTRY POINT TO THE HUMAN TRADITION: the tradition of humane living reproduces itself only through education-sanskar, because in human beings conduct is inherited through sanskar, not through birth. A generation educated in right understanding forms humane families, a humane society and a humane order — which then educates the next generation likewise. Wherever this cycle is broken (as today, where education teaches skills but not understanding), the repair must begin at the same joint: EDUCATION. Hence humanistic education — universal, rational, verifiable, all-encompassing — is not one reform among many but THE entry point into the humanistic tradition.
2. Q2. PROFESSION AS PARTICIPATION IN THE LARGER ORDER: every profession is a role within the larger systems of society and nature — the doctor participates in health-self-regulation, the engineer in production-work, the teacher in education-sanskar, the administrator in justice-preservation, the trader in exchange-storage. My professional value is therefore measured by how my work strengthens these dimensions toward the comprehensive human goal — not by salary or status alone. Practically: every design, diagnosis, lesson or judgment I deliver either moves some family or ecosystem toward mutual fulfilment or away from it — there is no neutral work.
3. Q3. WHY CODES OF CONDUCT AND PUNISHMENT ARE INSUFFICIENT: codes are EXTERNAL — they constrain behaviour without touching understanding; the person obeys while watched and circumvents when not (every elaborate corporate code coexists with recurring scandals). PUNISHMENT assumes fear deters — but it also teaches concealment, and it addresses acts after the damage, never the assumption that produced them. Both treat the human as driven by fear and greed, reinforcing the very animal consciousness that causes unethical conduct. Only right understanding changes conduct from within: a person who KNOWS why honesty is naturally acceptable is honest without supervision — ethics by clarity, not by surveillance.
4. Q4. ONE CLASSROOM/LAB FEATURE I would change: in our programming labs, replace the silent individual-copy culture with structured PAIR WORK with rotating 'guide' roles — where explaining to a peer is part of the assessed competence. This single feature builds GUIDANCE and CARE as lived values, converts competition into complementarity, and measures understanding rather than concealment. It costs nothing, requires no new syllabus, and immediately makes the classroom an expression of the humanistic education it should be transmitting.